



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Archangels Academy

School Website: <https://www.thearchangelsacademy.com/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Bishop Ryan Catholic School (<https://bishopryan.com/>) presents a strong Catholic identity with abundant liturgical life (daily prayer, daily Mass, liturgical-year celebrations) and an explicit emphasis on virtue in its public messaging. However, its academic program, as represented on the crawled pages, does not present hallmark features of a classical curriculum or pedagogy (e.g., the Trivium, Great Books, Socratic seminar, Latin as core), and it highlights modern program elements such as AP opportunities and customized learning plans. Net: Formation and worship are strong; classical curricular/pedagogical distinctives are not evident on the site materials reviewed.

Method: This audit uses the Positive/Negative Keyword Indicators drawn from Six Essential Elements of a Classical School and the companion lexicon to quantify signals across six categories (Religious & Metaphysical Foundations; Purpose & Goal; Curriculum; Pedagogy; Faculty; Parents & Community). These lexica define classical-positive terms such as truth, goodness, beauty; Trivium/Quadrivium; Great Books; Socratic; schol ; chanting; and cautionary/negative signals such as AP-heavy, personalized learning, project-based/experiential emphasis, and social studies replacing history.

School website used for this audit: <https://bishopryan.com/>

CATEGORY 1: RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS

1) Keywords found on the school site

- "Daily Prayer," "opportunity to attend daily Mass," "Religion classes," "Special celebrations throughout the liturgical year" (Who We Are)
- "works with parents and the Church to raise children in the faith" (Admissions/landing copy)
- "GLORY DAY" recurring religious event (Religious Formation calendar)

2) Match against Six Elements/lexicon

- Positive matches: liturgy, Mass, daily prayer, liturgical year, corporate worship, catechesis; all listed as positive indicators of liturgical/communal formation and theological grounding.
- Negative matches: none observed (no "religiously neutral," "values neutral," etc.).

3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive hits: 5; Negative hits: 0 → percent_positive ≈ 100%
- Coverage estimate: 75% (multiple distinct religious/ liturgical signals surfaced across pages)

4) Category rating

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- CLASSICAL. Strong, explicit commitment to worship, catechesis, and a communal liturgical life aligns with classical religious/metaphysical foundations.
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CATEGORY 2: SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL

1) Keywords found on the school site

- Tagline in page title: “Inspired Minds. Faithful Hearts. Lives of Virtue.” (includes “virtue”)
- “prepare future disciples,” “spiritual, character and moral development” (Who We Are)

2) Match against Six Elements/lexicon

- Positive matches: virtue, moral formation, discipleship/formation (goal beyond job prep). These align with “cultivation of wisdom and virtue” and formation over mere information.
- Missing classical-positive phrases: truth, goodness, beauty; wisdom (not observed on crawled pages).
- Negative matches: none observed (no “college and career ready” language).

3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive hits: 3; Negative hits: 0 → percent_positive ≈ 100%
- Coverage estimate: 50% (clear virtue/formation aims stated; fewer transcendental terms surfaced)

4) Category rating

- CLASSICAL. The stated telos emphasizes virtue and formation consistent with classical goals.
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CATEGORY 3: SCHOOL CURRICULUM

1) Keywords found on the school site

- “A strong core curriculum,” “Customized learning plans,” “Intervention Zone,” “After-school enrichment and homework help,” “Advanced Placement opportunities” (Who We Are)

Absent on crawled pages: - Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books/primary sources, Latin/Greek as core, explicit “history” in place of “social studies,” Great Conversation (no occurrences found)

2) Match against Six Elements/lexicon

- Positive classical signals expected: Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books, Latin, integration/wonder, history terminology. None observed.
- Negative signals observed: “Advanced Placement opportunities” (aligns with college-prep framing; listed among negative scholé/pressure markers in the pedagogy negatives), and “Customized learning plans” (akin to “personalized/individualized pathways,” a non-classical curricular signal in the negative lists).

3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive hits: 0; Negative hits: 2 → percent_positive ≈ 0%
- Coverage estimate: 35% (several academic signals surfaced but none of the classical curricular hallmarks)

4) Category rating

- NOT CLASSICAL. Current public-facing descriptions lack classical curricular distinctives and present modern program features (AP, customization) instead.

CATEGORY 4: SCHOOL PEDAGOGY OR TEACHING METHODS

1) Keywords found on the school site

- “After□school enrichment and homework help,” AP opportunities noted (Who We Are)

Absent on crawled pages: - Socratic dialogue/seminar, singing/chanting/recitation, memory work, scholé/restful learning, rhetoric/thesis/orations.

2) Match against Six Elements/lexicon

- Positive classical signals expected: Socratic, chanting/recitation, scholé/restfulness, rhetoric exercises. None observed.
- Negative signals observed: emphasis on AP opportunities is listed among pressures contrary to scholé (“AP□heavy curriculum,” “college preparatory focus”).

3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive hits: 0; Negative hits: 1 → percent_positive ≈ 0%
- Coverage estimate: 20% (few pedagogy descriptors surfaced)

4) Category rating

- NOT CLASSICAL. No evidence of signature classical teaching methods was found in the crawled content.
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CATEGORY 5: SCHOOL FACULTY

1) Keywords found on the school site

- “Dedicated teachers” (Who We Are)

2) Match against Six Elements/lexicon

- Positive classical signals expected: teachers as mentors/tutors/master□teachers, portrait of a teacher/student, collegial “faculty of friends,” teacher formation in classical pedagogy. Not present in the pages reviewed.
- Negative signals: none observed.

3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive hits: 1 (weak); Negative hits: 0 → percent_positive ≈ 100% of very low volume
- Coverage estimate: 15% (minimal faculty philosophy/formation detail published)

4) Category rating

- SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. Basic positive tone about teachers, but the site offers little evidence of a distinctively classical view of faculty as “living curriculum” or mentors.
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CATEGORY 6: SCHOOL PARENTS AND COMMUNITY

1) Keywords found on the school site

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- “Bishop Ryan Catholic School works with parents and the Church to raise children in the faith” (Admissions/landing copy)
 - “we work together in the raising of our children” (community emphasis)

2) Match against Six Elements/lexicon

- Positive matches: partnership with parents/co-educators/community of formation.
- Missing: explicit parent formation (book studies, seminars on classical education), open-campus/hospitality language tied to classical aims.

3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive hits: 2; Negative hits: 0 → percent_positive ≈ 100%
- Coverage estimate: 55% (clear partnership language; limited detail on parent formation in classical philosophy)

4) Category rating

- SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. Strong partnership language, but not specifically connected to classical parent formation practices.

Aggregate Assessment

- Religious & Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL
- Purpose & Goal: CLASSICAL
- Curriculum: NOT CLASSICAL
- Pedagogy: NOT CLASSICAL
- Faculty: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Parents & Community: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Overall: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Rationale: The school’s identity is richly Catholic and virtue-forward (formation, discipleship, liturgical life), which scores highly in the first two categories. However, the public academic program, as presented on crawled pages, does not display classical distinctives of curriculum and pedagogy (Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books, Latin, Socratic, scholé, chanting/memory), while featuring modern signals such as AP and customization. This mix places the school in the SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL band overall.

What would move the needle

If Bishop Ryan wishes to be recognized clearly as a classical school based on public materials: - Publish curricular distinctives: - Explicitly name the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and, where applicable, Quadrivium; list Latin (and/or Greek) as required/core; publish grade-level Great Books/primary source lists; use “history” rather than “social studies” as a course label.

- Describe pedagogy: - Highlight Socratic seminars (upper grades), chanting/recitation and memory work (lower grades), and an ethos of scholé/restful learning; showcase rhetoric deliverables (speeches, orations, theses).
- Clarify assessment/advanced work: - If AP remains, frame it as subordinate to classical goals (depth over speed), or publish classical capstones as the academic pinnacle (e.g., senior thesis/oration).
- Faculty profile: - Publish a “Portrait of a Teacher” emphasizing mentors/tutors as the living curriculum, with ongoing classical formation for faculty.
- Parent formation: - Offer and publicize classical education seminars/book clubs for parents; articulate the parent-school partnership in classical terms.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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